

7TH & 6TH CHORDS

Adding a 7th to any triad creates a richer 4-note sound. The type of 7th determines everything about function and emotional color.

THE 6 SEVENTH CHORD TYPES (ALL FROM C)

MAJOR 7TH
MAJ7

C–E–G–B
CΔ7 or Cmaj7

LUSH DREAMY STABLE

Major triad + major 7th. The 7th is only a half step below the root — creates beautiful tension that still feels resolved. Neo-soul, jazz, R&B staple.

DOMINANT 7TH
DOM7

C–E–G–B $\flat$
C7

TENSE DRIVING TRITONE

Major triad + minor 7th. The E and B $\flat$ form a tritone (THE engine of dominant function). The most harmonically active chord — must resolve. All V chords are dom7.

MINOR 7TH
MIN7

C–E $\flat$ –G–B $\flat$
Cm7

MELLOW JAZZY INTROSPECTIVE

Minor triad + minor 7th. Soft and introspective — the 7th smooths the minor sound. Used for ii chords in the ii-V-I. Standard jazz and neo-soul texture chord.

HALF-DIMINISHED
HALF-DIM

C–E $\flat$ –G $\flat$ –B $\flat$
Cø7 or Cm7 $\flat$ 5

DARK YEARNING MINOR II

Diminished triad + minor 7th. The ii chord in minor key ii-V-i. Darker than minor 7th but not fully tense like full-dim. Used extensively in jazz standards.

FULL DIMINISHED
DIM7

C–E $\flat$ –G $\flat$ –A
C°7

TENSE SPOOKY SYMMETRICAL

Diminished triad + diminished 7th (doubly diminished). Three stacked m3s — perfectly symmetrical. Only 3 unique sounds. Functions as rootless dominant 7 $\flat$ 9.

MINOR MAJOR 7TH
M(Δ7)

C–E $\flat$ –G–B
Cm(Δ7) or CmM7

DARK + BRIGHT SPY MOVIE COMPLEX

Minor triad + major 7th. The half-step between the maj7 (B) and the root (C) creates acute tension inside a dark minor frame. Dramatic, complex, cinematic. "Spy movie chord."

BRIGHTNESS RANKING — BRIGHTEST TO DARKEST



6TH CHORDS — THE HIDDEN ENHARMONIC IDENTITY

Major 6 (C6)

C–E–G–A

"Stable, vintage, complete"

C6 = Am7 (same notes, different root)

Minor 6 (Cm6)

C–E $\flat$ –G–A

"Dark, sophisticated, jazz"

Cm6 = Bø7 in 1st inversion (B–E $\flat$ –G–C)

THE PATTERN: MAJOR 6 = MINOR 7 RELATIONSHIP

C6	=	Am7 (1st inv)	Share C–E–G–A
G6	=	Em7 (1st inv)	Share G–B–D–E
F6	=	Dm7 (1st inv)	Share F–A–C–D